BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

INTRODUCTION

Introduction to Communication

- Communication means to create a common understanding. Communication is an important aspect of human behavior.
- It stands for natural activity of all human beings to convey opinions, feelings, information, and ideas to others through words (written or spoken), body language, or signs. Communication is an integral part of life.
- From birth till death every living being is communicating in his or her own way, be it birds, animals, trees or human beings.

Introduction

- **Communication:**

- *"Communication is the transfer of information, idea, opinion, attitude etc. from a sender to a receiver with a view to making it understandable to the latter."*
- According to Gary Dessler, "Communication is the exchange of information and the transmission of meaning".
- According to Elliot Jaquer, " Communication is the sum total of directly and indirectly, consciously and unconsciously transmitted feelings, attitudes, and wishes".

Some Definitions of Communication

- Accordingly to Murphy and Peck, **"Communication is a two-way process of exchanging ideas or information between human beings".**

- According to R.S Davar, " **Communication is the process of meaningful interaction among persons in an organization, resulting in meanings being perceived and understandings effected among such persons".**

Business communication

- The word Business stands for any economic activity undertaken with a view to earn profit.
- The communication undertaken in the process of this activity is termed as business communication.
- From the very inception of the idea of the Business, to run the day to day activities of the Business, communication is involved. It includes oral, written, formal, informal, upward, downward, lateral, diagonal, inward outwards as well as non verbal communication.

Business communication

- **Business communication** is information sharing among people within and outside an organization that is performed for the commercial benefit of the organization.

- In addition, business communication can also refer to how a company shares information to promote its product or services to potential consumers.

Communication - The life blood of an organization

- Communication is often referred to as the lifeblood of a business organization because it serves as the vital conduit through which information, ideas, and instructions flow. Here's why it's considered so crucial:
- **Coordination**: The achievement of organizational objectives largely depends upon a proper co-ordination and integration of human effort in an organization. The people working in an organization are interrelated; their activities are also interrelated because all activities are performed only to achieve the organizational objectives. Co-ordination and integration of various human activities are possible only if there is an effective system of communication in the organization which provides for exchange of information and sharing of various ideas. The more effective the system of communication, the better is the relation between workers and the management.

- **Decision Making**: Good communication ensures that relevant information reaches decision-makers in a timely and accurate manner. This enables informed decision-making, which is essential for the smooth functioning and success of any business.
- **Problem Solving**: When issues arise, clear communication is essential for identifying, understanding, and resolving them efficiently. It allows for open dialogue, brainstorming, and collaboration to find effective solutions.
- **Employee Engagement**: Transparent and open communication fosters trust and engagement among employees. It helps them feel valued, informed, and connected to the organization's mission and vision, which can boost morale and productivity.

- **Customer Relations**: Communication is not limited to internal interactions; it's equally important for maintaining relationships with customers and clients. Clear communication builds trust, enhances customer satisfaction, and fosters loyalty.
- **Innovation and Adaptation**: Effective communication encourages the sharing of ideas and feedback, which is essential for innovation and adaptation to changing market conditions. It creates an environment where creativity can flourish and new opportunities can be explored.
- **Conflict Resolution**: Conflicts are inevitable in any organization, but effective communication can help manage and resolve them constructively. It enables parties to express their concerns, listen to each other's perspectives, and find mutually acceptable solutions.

Effective Communication

- Effective communication definition is the process of exchanging or transmitting ideas, information, thoughts, knowledge, data, opinion, or messages from the sender through a selected method or channel to the receiver with a purpose that can be understood with clarity.

Elements of Communication

Sender:

- One who sends the message is the sender.
- Sender send a message either the writer or speaker, depending upon whether the communication is written or oral. Sender is the encoder of the message. Message include symbols, usually words that will correctly and tactfully express the message. So, the receiver will understand it and react with desired response. Both internal and external stimuli affect message encoding and sending.

Elements of Communication

Message:

- The sender translates his ideas into a message.
- The message may consist of both verbal, written or spoken symbols and nonverbal symbols to convey ideas from the sender to the receiver.

Elements of Communication

Channel:

- The medium used to convey the message is the channel.
- The choice or medium is influenced by the inter relationship of sender and receiver.
- If the message requires an immediate answer or if it contains bad news for the receiver an oral channel may be the better choice.
- If the message contains complicated details and figures or if its subject requires filing for future reference, a written communication is necessary.

Elements of Communication

Receiver:

- The message receiver is the reader or listener and decoder of the message.
- The receiver as well as he sender are influenced by external environment and internal stimuli.
- A problem is that all of us do not have identical experience with the subject or the symbols a sender uses.
- Attitudes, abilities, opinions, communications skills, and cultural customs of receiver and sender of message usually vary.

Elements of Communication

- Ultimately the receiver reacts, either with a response based on clear interpretation of the symbols or an incorrect response because of miscommunication

Elements of Communication

- **Feedback:**

- Feedback is the receiver's reaction.
- Receiver's reaction indicating to the sender whether or not the message has been understood and correctly interpreted.
- Feedback creates a two way process of communication rather than a simple send receive relationship.

Elements of Communication

- Feedback may be a simple ”yes” or “No” or a request for further clarification.
- If the receiver incorrectly perceives the message, that is miscommunication.
- The success or failure of the communication is indicated by the feedback.

Thank You

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

INTRODUCTION

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Objectives of Communication

- Behind objectives of management there is an objectives. Communication is alone with some objectives in mind such as:

1. **Receiving or Passing Information:**

   Managerial decisions are to be based on right information which may be either external or internal.

- **External Information**, being concerned with outside world, may relate to the following:

a). **Demand for products in the market:** Manager can not take production or marketing decision without having this information.

Objectives of Communication

b). Strategies for competitors: One who is ignorant about the strategies of competitors may fail in business.

c). Supply of labor and raw-materials: A manager has to have information about the sources of supply of labor and raw material.

d). Government Policies: Ignorance about government policies may be disastrous. An importer, for example, has to know about the import policy of the government.

e). Technological developments: No business can run properly without having information about and illustration of latest technologies.

Objectives of Communication

f). Changes in tastes and fashions: Information about changes in tastes and fashion help managers to keep pace with needs of market.

- Management has to collect such information in order to reduce uncertainty in decisions, and the dissemination of these information help to take proper decision.

- **Internal Information,** on the other hand, generate within the organization. They may relate to the following:

a). Job performance of employees: Information about job performance of employees is essential for managerial decisions relating to employees.

Objectives of Communication

b). Disciplinary conditions in the work place: Such information help management to take corrective actions.

c). Job Assignment: Job related proper job assignment ensure success of management.

d). Demand for employees, raw materials, machinery and spare parts: These demands come from within and must be taken care of.

e). Need for money, etc.: Management has to be well aware about the need for finance and such other things.

Objectives of Communication

❒ *The source of information may be:*

⇨ Company records,

⇨ Library Search,

⇨ Observations and Interviews,

⇨ Mass media,

⇨ Meetings, workshops, and seminars,

⇨ Exhibitions and trade fairs,

⇨ Internet, etc.

Objectives of Communication

2. **Giving advice to colleagues/subordinates:**

Advice is given in order to influence the attitudes, opinions, behavior etc. of individuals concerned. It flows order either horizontally or downwards. There are some tips to make advice effective.

❒ *Tips to make advice effective:*

⇨ It should be given in such a way that it suits the need of the recipient.

⇨ The advisor should be courteous and polite.

⇨ The advise should be given for the betterment of the staff concerned.

⇨ The recipient of advice should be given freedom to react.

Objectives of Communication

3. Counseling the problem Employees:

Counseling is almost similar to giving advice.

Advice	Counsel
Subjective by nature	Objective by nature
Advice has a personal touch	Counsel is almost professional
Advice may be unwelcome	Counsel is eagerly sought

In most modern industrial enterprises, therefore, industrial counselor are appointed.

Objectives of Communication

4. Issuing Orders:

It is a top-down approach. It is authoritative and is issued as a directive to subordinates. Orders may be of the following types:

a). Written or Oral:

☞Written order is preferred when the task is repetitive and it is essential to keep a record of the order given.

☞Oral order is preferred where the job is required to be done immediately and also there is no need for maintaining any record of the order given.

b). General and Specific:

General order becomes binding for everyone of a group whereas specific order is meant for an specific individual.

c). Mandatory and discretionary:

Mandatory orders are to be obeyed, they can't be avoided.

Discretionary orders are not compulsory on the part of the receiver.

d). Procedural and Operational :

Procedural orders specify procedures to be adopted in doing a job.

Operational orders indicate the operation to be carried out.

Objectives of Communication

❒ *Features of an effective order:*

⇨ Order must be precise, complete and clear.

⇨ Execution of order must not be impossible.

⇨ Order should be given in such a way that it is accepted cordially.

5. To persuade:

Persuasion may be thought of as an effort to influence someone for getting desired result.

Persuasion is suggestive, not authoritative.

Objectives of Communication

- It is an art and is composed of four important steps such as-
  - Analyzing the situation,
  - Preparing the receiver,
  - Delivering the message,
  - prompting action.

Objectives of Communication

6. Raising Morale and Motivation:

☞Moral indicates mental health.

☞ Motivation stands for an inner urge of individual to put to the maximum efforts to attain the goal.

7. Giving Warning:

Employees may require warning if they violate or try to violate the discipline

☞Warning should be given for the betterment of the organization or of the employees concerned. of the organization.

Objectives of Communication

- ☞ If the warning is related to a particular person, it will be called *particular warning* .
- ☞ If the warning is given to all the members of a group it will be known as *general warning.*

Objectives of Communication

8. Educating Employees and Prospective Consumers:

☞ Employee can educated through training. Internal communication may help educate managers and other employees in different ways.

⇨ seminars,

⇨ Workshops,

⇨ Conference may educate managers about latest principles and practices of management.

☞ Workers can also be educated in

⇨ Fire drills,

Objectives of Communication

- ⇨Security measures, productivity improvements etc. through oral, verbal and audio-visual means of communication.
- ☞ External communication, may be used to educate prospective customers about the uses and benefits of products and services offered. They may also prohibited to use certain harmful products or services through communication.
- ☞Whatever the objective of communication is the main objective is to transfer an information , for various purpose.

Main Forms of Business Communication

- There are three categories of Business Communication.
- **Internal Operational Communication**
- **External Operational Communication**

&

- **Personal**

Main Forms of Business Communication

➢**Internal Operational Communication:**

- The communication done in conducting work within a business.
- This is the communication among the business's workers that is done to create, implement and track the success of the business's operating plan.

Main Forms of Business Communication

➢External Operational Communication

- Work related communication with people outside the business.
- External Communication includes all of the business efforts at direct selling like: *personal selling, telephoning, advertising and writing message.*
- Every external message conveys an image of the company.
- External and Internal communication both are important for the business success.

Main Forms of Business Communication

➢**Personal Communication**

- Non-business related exchanges of information and feelings among people.
- Personal communication affects employee attitudes and attitudes affects employee performance.
- The kinds of personal communication allowed and encouraged in the company affect employee attitudes.
- Personal communication elements can enhance internal and external business communication.

Some Basic truths about Communication

- The communication process reveals some basic truth.
- **Meaning Is In The Mind, and No Two Minds Are Alike.**
- **The Symbols for Communicating Are Imperfect, and So Are Our Best Communication Efforts.**
- **Communication is about Information and Relationship.**

Thank You

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

COMMUNICATION MODEL

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Nature of Communication Model

- Model refers to the representation of a process, an event or a situation. It does not show the details message, rather it only represent the elements which is the reason of sending the message.

- **Communication Model**

  A model of communication is a symbolic representation of the communication process.

- **According to W.R. Tracy,**

  " Communication model is representation of a communication process and not any separate system; rather a simple way to present the various objective oriented events".

Types of Communication Models

- Several models have been identified by communication theorists. All models include at least three elements:

⇨ ***A receiver***

⇨ ***A massage,***

⇨ ***A source.***

There are some communication models, each giving a little different perspective.

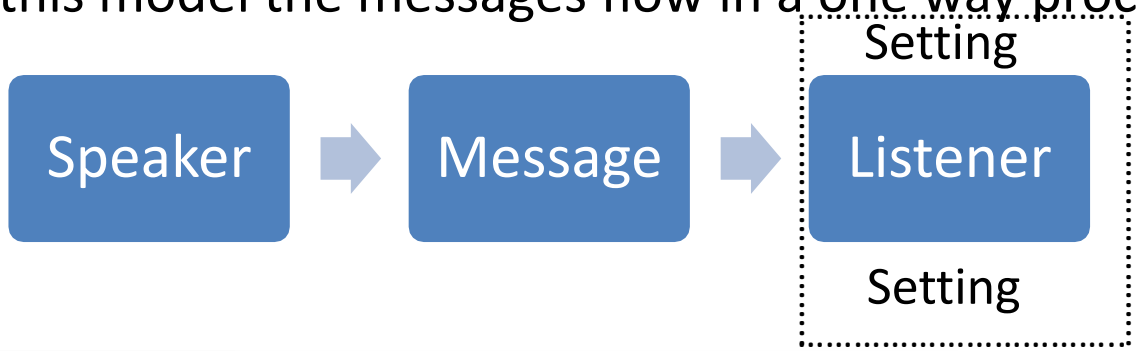
Types of Communication Models

❶ Aristotelian Persuation Model

It is the oldest and simplest model of communication. According to Aristotle- "The form of communication is persuasive in nature." This model does not include all the elements of communication. It includes only three elements of communication such as

- Speaker,
- Message, and
- Listener/Receiver.

In this model the messages flow in a one way process.



Types of Communication Models

❷ Hovland model of Communication

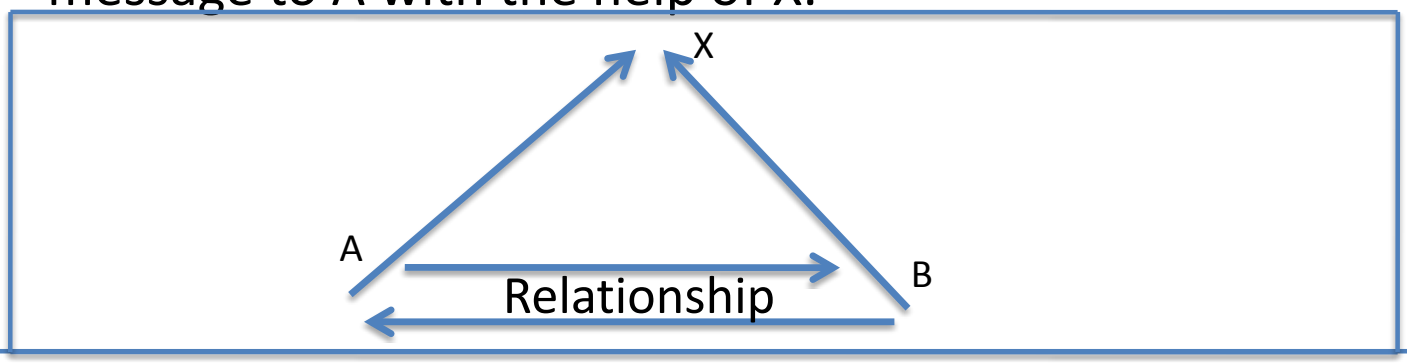
This model of communication is almost similar to Aristotelian persuation model, the only difference is that in Hovland model the listener will be in a pre-determined position. According to Hovland, the message is sent to a pre-determined listener and the listener also gives his reaction to the speaker.

Types of Communication Models

❸ The Newcomb Interpersonal Model

the Newcomb interpersonal model is one of the simplest models of communication. Newcomb advocate that "communication between the sender and the receiver takes place through a third person."

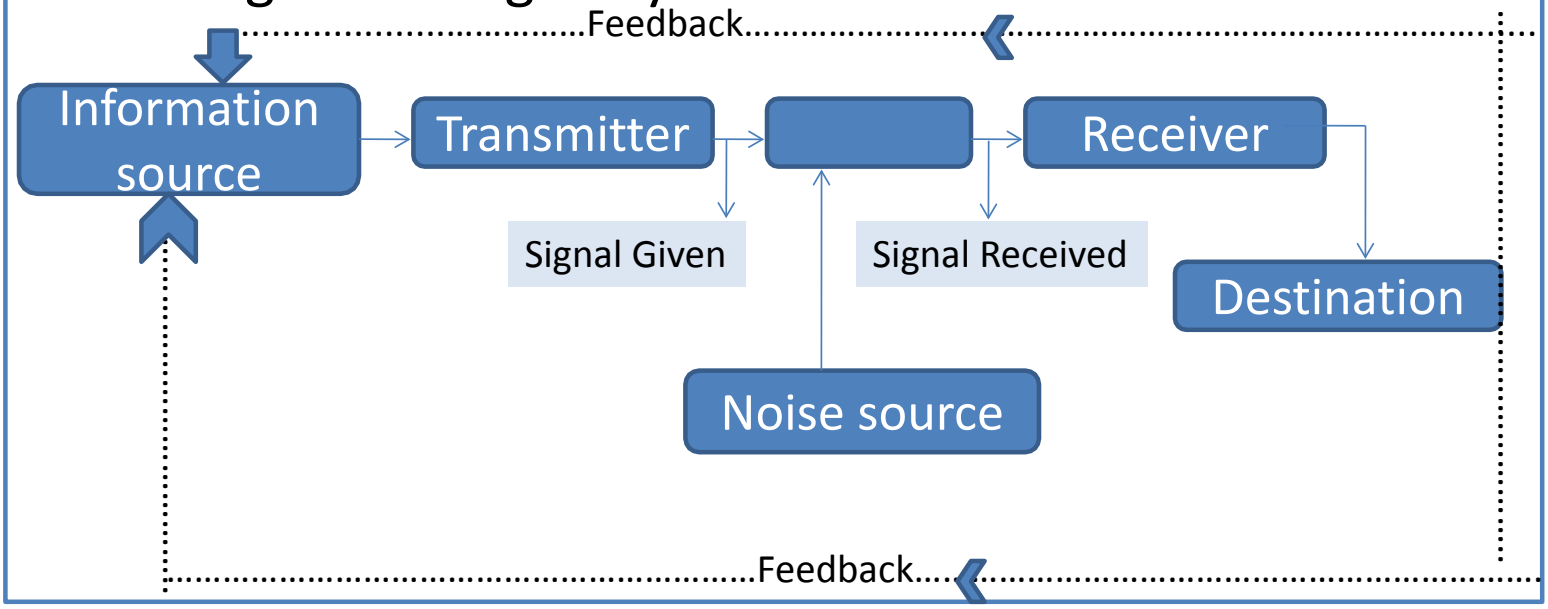
Suppose, A wants to communicate a message to B. But B is not known to him. Another person X is known to both A and B. Hence, A will communicate the message to B through the help of X. And also B will communicate message to A with the help of X.



Types of Communication Models

❹ Shanon and Weaver's information theory Model

This model involves an information source which selects a desired message, a transmitter which changes the message and it is sent through some communication channel to a receiver to whom the message was originally intended.



Types of Communication Models

➢ A noise source means any interference with the transmission and reception of the message. The noise may be two types:

⇨ **Mechanical Noise:**

- It comes from any mechanical source.

⇨ **Semantic Noise:**

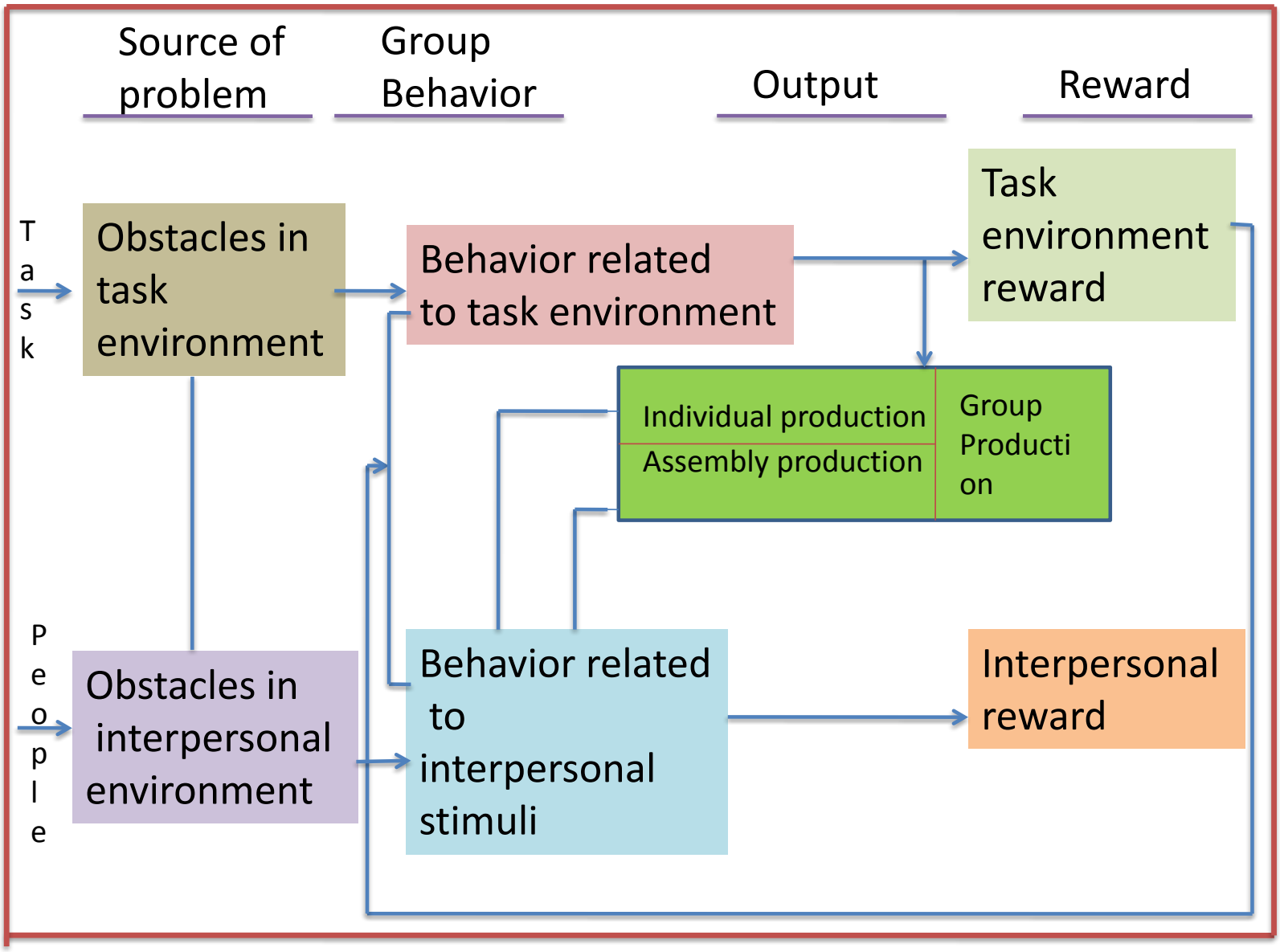
- Difference between the meaning intended by the sender and the receiver of the message.

Types of Communication Models

❺ **Collin's and Guetzkuw's group Communication Model:**

It deals with communication in the decision making group which occurs as basic part of organizational communication.

- In below the top three boxes represent the source, behavior, and reward associated with the task aspects of group operation, while the lower three boxes represents the source, behavior and reward associated with interpersonal aspects of group operation.
- Obstacle in the task environment and interpersonal environment affects the group's interpersonal communication behavior.


Source of problem
Group Behavior
Output
Reward
Task
Obstacles in task environment
People
Obstacles in interpersonal environment
Behavior related to task environment
Behavior related to interpersonal stimuli
Task environment reward
Individual production
Assembly production
Group Production
Interpersonal reward

Types of Communication Models

❻ Thayer's Organizational Model

Thayer emphasizes upon individual communication efforts within the large organizational communication setting.

- It is **based on levels** of communication. The levels are

(i) *Organizational*

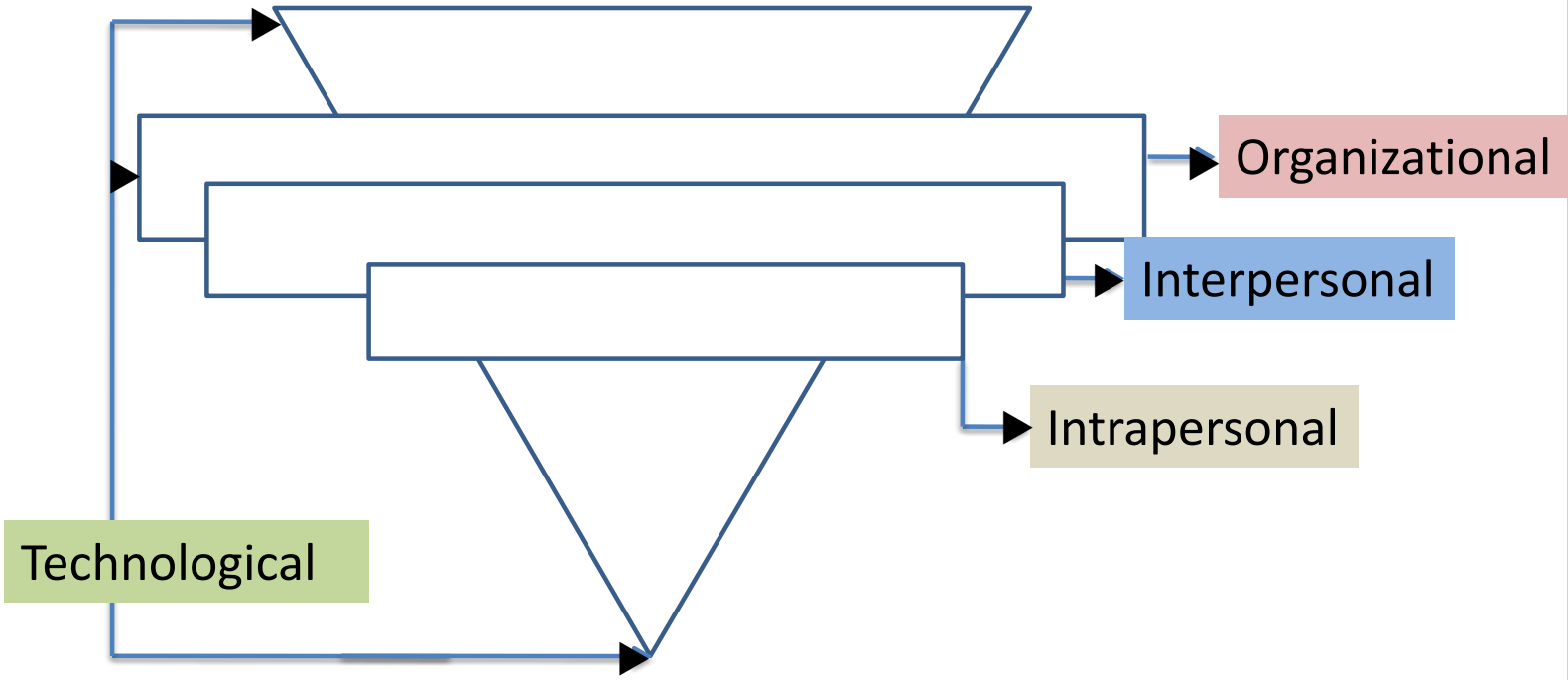
(ii) *Interpersonal*

(iii) *Intrapersonal*

(iv) *Technological* which are derived from four basic sources or determinates of human communication behavior.

- The **basic sources** are:

physiological, psychological, sociological, technical



Thayer's Communication Model

Types of Communication Models

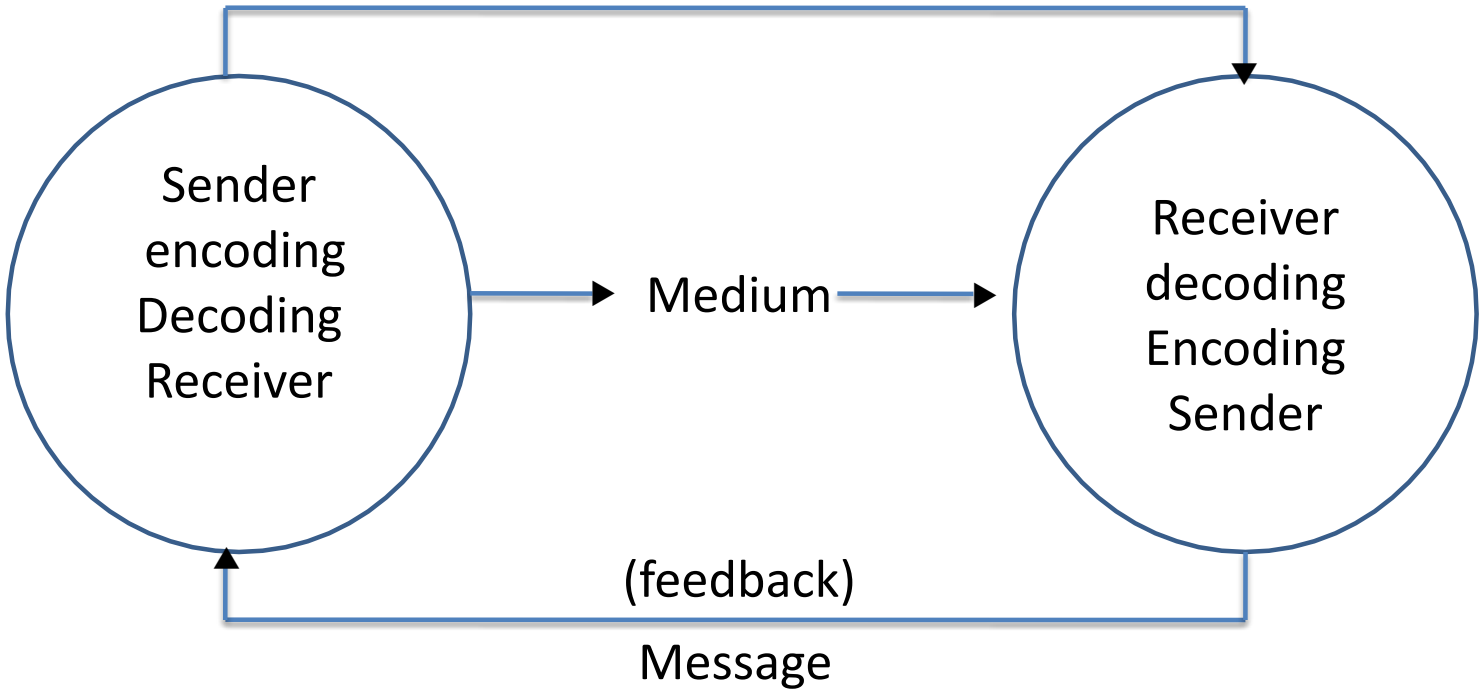
❼ Wenburg and Wilmot's Transactional Model

The transaction model represents the communication as a process of simultaneous message exchange. According to Wenburg and Wilmot, " All persons are engaged in sending (encoding) and receiving (decoding) messages simultaneously. Each person is constantly sharing in the encoding and decoding process and each person is affecting the others."

Types of Communication Models

- The transactional model emphasizes the idea that communication is mutual as well as reciprocal.
- The transaction model is most appropriately used in situation where face-to-face communication occurs through speech and various non-verbal behavior.

Types of Communication Models



- In the transactional model, communication takes place without sharp distinction between the source and receiver roles. A person occupies both roles at the some time.

Most Acceptable Communication Model

- From all of these models, transactional model of communication is considered to be the most acceptable on the following grounds:
- It brings fulfillment in communication process because all the elements of communication process are present here.
- Without any feedback communication is supposed to be incomplete. The transactional model emphasizes more on feedback and therefore, gives a full view of communicational process.

Most Acceptable Communication Model

- Transactional model reflects simplicity and thereby, anybody can easily understand the actual content of the message.
- Obtaining the concise and complete information through exchanging the message between the sender and the receiver under transactional model, the decision making task is very simple.

Difference between the process and Model of communication

- The communication process and communicational model both represent how communication works at individual and organizational life.
- The aspects of communication are just like the two sides of the same coin.
- It may seem that, communicational model and communicational process are one and the same thing.
- But in spite of having many similarities between the two, they differ from each other in some respects.

Significance of Communication Model

- The significance of communication model can be described as under:

⇨ It is pictorial representation of the communication process which provides complete idea regarding the message.

⇨ It can use the various elements of communication which may be considered as a sample for further research and investigation.

⇨ It represents the objectives and relevant aspects regarding the message sent and therefore creates a meaningful picture.

⇨ To understand the nature of inflexibility, communication model can be an effective source.

⇨ It helps us to measure the effectiveness of communication and also helps in decision making.

Usefulness of Communicational Model

- A communication model shows the picture of a situation and also the diagram of the process of communication.
- **Better understanding:** as communication model is diagrammatic, we better understand the situation and process of communication with the help of a model.
- **Quick understanding:** a communication model exhibits the main elements of a communication process, so we can quickly generate an idea in our mind about the utility and effectiveness of the model at a glance.

Usefulness of Communicational Model

- **improvement over traditional model:** traditional organizational models are not competent to fully display the ongoing flow of messages among the officers and employees. A communication model displays the horizontal channel between the people at the same level.

Usefulness of Communicational Model

- **Facilitating communication plan:** models are used to help us plan communication efforts. If any change is brought about in the policy matters, just look at the chart, convert it to communication model, look at the media available to the organization and in the above light and draw up a plan ensuring a changed policy to everybody in the organization.
- **Feedback facility:** communication is never a one-way process. Models remind us that it is a two way process. There are always at least two people and frequently many more involved in the exchange of a message.

Usefulness of Communicational Model

- **Using as a sample:** since a communication model represents a pictorial statement of the elements of a communication process, a researcher while conducting research on communication process, finds I convenient to use a communication model as a sample for the purpose.

Limitations of communication Model

- Communication models are useful in many ways. Still they suffer from some limitations. Among them following are important:

⇨ **Details of a message are absent:** A model is a symbolic representation of a communication process. Details of a message are not available in a model which hinders to reach a sound decision.

⇨ **Difficult to form an idea about a complete message:** As a model is a symbolic representation, only very important elements are presented in it. The less important elements are not shown . It becomes very difficult to form an idea about complex message from a model.

Limitations of communication Model

- **Inflexibility cannot be presented:** Communication is an ever changing process. We never know with certainty what works and what does not. This inflexibility can not be represented in a model.
- **May not be cost effective:** Formulation of communication model for transmitting message requires a lot of valuable time. But the benefits may be less from the cost of application.
- **Requirement of skilled manpower may remain unfulfilled**: To run the communication model properly, effective manpower is essential. But such man power may not always be available.

Thank You

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION

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Introduction

- There are various types of communication.

- They may varied from several angels___

- Based on levels of communication,
  - Intrapersonal,
  - Interpersonal,
  - Small group,
  - Mass communication.

Introduction

▣ **Formalities of communication**

⦿ Formal communication

⦿ Informal communication

▣ **Method of communication**

⦿ Written,

⦿ Oral,

⦿ Face-to-face communication,

⦿ Electronic communication.

▣ **Direction of communication**

⦿ External,

⦿ Internal,

⦿ Vertical,

⦿ Horizontal,

Based on levels of communication

⦿**Intrapersonal Communication:**

"Communication occurring within an individual is called intrapersonal communication."

- Feinberg states, "Intrapersonal communication, communicating with self, occurs when we think, feel or act, as well as when we verbalize to ourselves".
- Intrapersonal communication may also be termed self-communication.

Based on levels of communication

⦿ **Interpersonal Communication:**

- *"Interpersonal communication is the process of sending and receiving a message from one person to another."*
- A striking features of interpersonal communication is that it generally

– spontaneous,

– Loosely organized,

– Unplanned.

“Difference between Intrapersonal & Interpersonal communication”

Business Communication

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Based on levels of communication

⦿ **Small Group Communication:**

"Small group communication happens when more than two people are involved in communicating a message face-to-face."

- This type of communication is formed for a specific purpose.
- An ideal size of a small group where the number of members varies between five and nine.

Based on levels of communication

⦿ Mass Communication:

- The term mass communication indicates a process through which a message is widely circulated among the persons who are far away from the source.
- *"Mass communication is a process though which professional communicators design and use intermediary channel (radio, TV, Newspaper), to disseminate messages quickly at a time to a large number of heterogeneous audience."*

Based on Formalities in Communication

- ❒ Communication may or may not go by formalities.
- ▣ **Formal Communication:**

  If communication takes place between two or more formal positions and in relation to function of an organization then it has to be done in conformity with the discipline, procedures, rules, regulations etc. of the organization concerned.

Based on Formalities in Communication

- **Informal Communication**:

  If two or more persons, although holding some organizational positions, communicate on some personal grounds and levels, compliance of organizational discipline, rules etc. is beyond question.

“Distinction between Formal And Informal Communication”

Business Communication

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Based on Methods of Communication

- A communicator can transmit the message in different ways-
  - In writing,
  - By speaking face-to-face or
  - By using electronic/computer devices.
- On the basis of symbols used communication may be of mainly three types:
  - Written
  - Oral,
  - Electronic/computer based.

Based on Methods of Communication

⦿**Written communication:**

"A message communicated in a written from is known as written communication."

⦿ **Oral Communication:**

"In oral communication spoken words are used to express meaning."

⦿ **Face-to-face Communication:**

"Face-to-face communication are almost oral. Telephonic conversation, voice over internet, voice mail etc. are oral but not face-to-face."

– When communication transfer with the presence of two persons.

Based on Methods of Communication

- **Electronic Communication:**
  - Electronic communication (e-communication) involves collection, processing, storage, and distribution of information through electronic device.

Based on Direction of communication

▣ The direction of communication may take any of the following patterns:

⦿ External communication

⦿ Internal Communication

⦿ Vertical Communication

① Downward communication

② Upward Communication

⦿ Horizontal communication.

Based on Direction of communication

⦿ **External communication:**

- External communication takes place with outsiders.
- An external communication serve the purpose of making contact with outsiders so as to know from them issues of their mutual interest.

⦿ **Internal Communication:**

- Communication occurring within the some organization structure is called internal communication.

“Distinction between Internal & External Communication”

Business Communication

Dr. Abdul Awal Khan

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Based on Direction of communication

⊙ **Vertical Communication:**

- Vertical communication can be both downward and upward.

① **Downward Communication:**

- Downward communication is a process of sending a message from a superior to a subordinate.
- The purpose of downward communication is to supply the subordinates with relevant information instruction etc.

Based on Direction of communication

② Upward Communication:

– Upward communication flows from one level of an organization or a group to a higher level.

– The main purpose of upward communication is to know if the subordinates have properly received the message.

Based on Direction of communication

- **Horizontal Communication:**

- Communication between the individuals of the same level or group within the same departments or across departments is called horizontal communication.

- The overall purpose of horizontal communication is to quickly facilitate the co-ordination of activities across different departments of the organization.

Thank You